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BRAND & IDENTITY BRIEF · V1

SFDesk

A mini storefront your customers order from, plus an order desk that tracks every order — for shops that sell over Instagram and WhatsApp DMs.

PREPARED FOR

Logo & identity designer

FROM

Mohamed Farhat

DATE

24 September 2026

DOMAIN

sfdesk.lk

WHAT THIS DOCUMENT IS

The product is built and live. Its colour system, typography and design language already exist and are shipping — this document captures them so the logo is designed **into** the product rather than onto it.

Everything here is descriptive, not prescriptive. The palette and type are settled; the mark is entirely open. If something in the existing system fights a stronger idea, say so — the logo is the more permanent decision.

The single most important constraint: the mark's smallest real home is a 24 × 24 px rounded tile in a navigation bar, and a 16 px browser favicon. It is never large. Legibility at thumbnail size outranks detail, gradient and cleverness. See section 07.

CONTENTS

01	The product & who it serves	05	Typography
02	Positioning & personality	06	Design language
03	The name & concept territories	07	Where the logo lives (sizes)
04	Colour	08	The product in context
		09	Deliverables & acceptance

01 The product & who it serves

SFDesk replaces the Instagram-DM order mess with two things: a public mini storefront, and a private order desk. Nothing more — deliberately.

THE PROBLEM

Small sellers run real businesses out of their DMs. Orders arrive as messages, get buried under new messages, and there is no list of what's owed, packed or delivered.

The alternative on offer is a full website — priced and scoped for a business twice their size. There is no cheap, correctly-scoped middle step.

THE PRODUCT

Storefront. A link the seller drops in their bio. Customers browse, build a basket, and send it straight to the seller's WhatsApp as a formatted message.

There is no checkout and never will be.

Desk. Where the seller works: catalog, orders, payment and delivery status, customers, exports. Phone-first, one-handed, mid-conversation.

Two audiences, one mark

This matters more for the logo than anything else in the brief. The mark has to work in two visually separate worlds, for two people who want opposite things.

Audience	Who they are	Where they see the mark	What it must say to them
The seller our customer	Owner-operator of a small shop. Sells clothes, food, plants, crafts. Runs the business from a phone between other jobs. Not technical. Price-sensitive — the product is ~1/20th the cost of a website.	Marketing site, signup, the desk sidebar every working day, receipts and emails.	"This is a real tool, run by someone competent, and it will not embarrass me or waste my money."
The buyer our customer's customer	Someone who tapped a link in an Instagram bio. Has never heard of us and does not need to. On a phone, on mobile data, deciding in seconds whether this shop is real.	Only one place: a small powered by SFDesk line in the storefront footer.	Almost nothing — and that is the point. It must recede . The shop's brand is the hero; ours is a quiet credit.

The design consequence

The storefront is intentionally **monotone by default** (near-black accent) so each shop's own colour and logo can take over. Our mark has to sit inside someone else's branding without clashing — which argues for a mark that reads correctly in **one flat colour**, including plain black and plain white, before it has any colour of its own.

PRICE POINT

LKR 1,500 / month on the entry plan, 14-day trial, no card. Three tiers: Basic, Studio, Pro.

SCALE AMBITION

Hundreds of small shops, not dozens of large ones. Self-serve from signup to cancellation — no salesperson, no onboarding call.

HARD CEILING

Never a website builder, never a payment processor. One configurable layout. The mark should feel focused, not platform-grand.

02 Positioning & personality

The product's voice is already written and shipping. These are the adjectives it actually earns — not aspirational ones.

01 • PLAIN-SPOKEN

Says the thing, then stops

No “empower”, no “revolutionise”, no exclamation marks. Real product copy: **“Browse and send your order straight to our DMs.”** The mark should be as direct — a clear idea, not a puzzle.

02 • COMPETENT

Built, not mocked up

The credibility problem is real: we are asking a shop to run its orders through us. The identity must look engineered — precise edges, deliberate spacing — rather than friendly and hand-drawn.

03 • SMALL-BUSINESS WARM

Not enterprise-cold

Our user is one person with a phone, not a procurement team. Blue does the trustworthy work; a warm second colour keeps it human. Avoid corporate-SaaS sterility.

04 • CORRECTLY SCOPED

Proud of being small

We compete by being the right size, not the biggest. The mark can be modest and specific. A grand abstract swoosh would be a lie.

05 • EDITORIAL, NOT BUBBLY

Crisp over friendly

A deliberate correction made mid-build: the first storefront design was rejected as **“too rounded and generic”**. Everything got tighter, flatter, more typographic. The logo must not undo that.

06 • QUIET

Infrastructure, not celebrity

On the storefront we are a footnote under someone else's brand. The mark should be comfortable being small and grey.

IT IS

- A working tool with an opinion
- Precise, flat, typographic
- Trustworthy in the way a bank statement is
- Legible at 16 pixels and in one colour
- Happy to sit second to the shop's own brand

IT IS NOT

- A startup mascot, a gradient blob, or a friendly character
- Rounded, soft, bubbly or playful-first
- Enterprise-abstract (swooshes, cubes, hexagons, orbits)
- Detailed, illustrative, or dependent on gradient
- Trying to look like Shopify or a payments company

Voice samples from the live product

Useful for calibrating tone — this is how the brand already speaks.

Where	What it says
Marketing headline	“Take orders from your DMs.”
Storefront tagline	“Browse and send your order straight to our DMs.”
Basic plan	“Everything you need to take orders from your DMs.”
Studio plan	“Make the storefront look unmistakably yours.”
Pro plan	“For shops heading toward a full website.”
Onboarding email	“We build one system for everyone — if you hit something that doesn't fit, tell us, and if enough people hit the same thing, it becomes a real feature.”

03 The name & concept territories

SFDesk = Storefront + Desk. The two halves of the product, in the order the user meets them.

READING & SETTING

Written: SFDesk — one word, capital S, capital F, capital D, no space, no hyphen, no camel-case gap. Never “SF Desk”, “sfdesk” in prose, or “SFdesk”.

Said: “ess-eff-desk”.

Domain: sfdesk.lk — the lettering may need to read well alongside a visible domain in marketing.

LOCKUP OPPORTUNITY

The name has a natural two-part rhythm: an abbreviation followed by a plain English word. A two-weight or two-tone wordmark (**SF** + Desk) is worth exploring — it encodes the product structure without illustration.

“SF” also gives an easy monogram for the square tile, which is the size-critical asset. Whether the tile carries SF, a single S, or an abstract mark is open.

Concept territories

Starting points, not a shortlist — ordered roughly by how well they fit the positioning. Explore whatever earns its place.

Territory	The idea	Why it fits / watch out
The desk itself STRONGEST	A counter, a work surface, a single horizontal line with something resting on it. The literal second half of the name, and the emotional promise: a place where the mess becomes orderly.	Fits “competent, plain-spoken”. Reduces cleanly to a mark at 16 px. Risk: a plain line is easy to make forgettable — it needs one specific gesture.
Order into line STRONGEST	Scattered marks resolving into a neat stack or list. The product’s actual value in one image: chaos in, order out.	Conceptually the truest. Watch out: “rows of lines” is a crowded visual space (every task app). Needs a distinctive count, rhythm or crop.
Storefront geometry	An awning, a shutter, a doorway, a shop window — abstracted to two or three shapes.	Warm, small-business, unmistakably retail. Watch out: awnings skew cute and illustrative fast, and stripes vanish at small sizes.

EXISTING PLACEHOLDER

Today the product renders a plain letter **S** on a filled rounded tile. It is a placeholder with no equity — ignore it entirely, it is shown in this brief only to mark the position and size the real mark must fill.

SHOP LETTER-TILES

A related pattern worth knowing: shops with no logo of their own get an automatic letter-tile in the storefront nav. Whatever we design should not be confusable with that generic fallback.

03b Concept territories, continued

Territory	The idea	Why it fits / watch out
SF monogram	S and F interlocked, overlapped, or sharing a stem, inside the square tile.	Guaranteed to survive at 16 px and reads as a real company. Watch out: monograms say nothing about what we do — carries less meaning than the others.
Message → record	The core transformation: a DM becoming a tracked order. A bubble squaring off into a card or a line item.	Explains the product instantly to a seller. Watch out: chat bubbles are a cliché — only viable if the bubble is clearly becoming something else.
The tile / card	Lean into the container: the 24 px rounded square is already the brand's shape in the product. Make the tile the logo, with a minimal internal gesture.	Honest about where the mark actually lives, and native to the UI. Watch out: needs to still work when the container is removed (social, print, one-colour).

Please avoid

Shopping carts and shopping bags (we deliberately have no checkout — a cart would misdescribe the product). Generic chat bubbles used as-is. Gradient-dependent marks and 3-D perspective. Anything with a shadow or a highlight baked in. Mascots. Marks that need more than two colours, or that stop working in solid black.

Visual reference cues

Not brands to imitate — qualities to aim at. Described rather than shown, so the drawing stays yours.

FEELS RIGHT

The lettering on a **well-printed receipt** or a **shipping label** — functional, mono-adjacent, unglamorous, trustworthy because it isn't trying.

FEELS RIGHT

A **hand-painted shop sign** reduced to its geometry: the confidence of a small business that has been there twenty years, with the decoration stripped out.

FEELS RIGHT

Modern **developer-tool marks** — flat, single-weight, one clear geometric idea, equally legible in a browser tab and on a sticker.

FEELS WRONG

Marketplace-app logos — bright gradients, rounded blobs, a smiling bag. Cheerful, generic, and indistinguishable from forty others.

FEELS WRONG

Fintech abstraction — overlapping translucent shapes, orbit paths, the letter-in-a-circle. Says “funded startup”, says nothing about shops.

FEELS WRONG

Craft / artisanal — script, badges, laurels, textured stamps. Wrong register entirely: we are the system, not the shop.

If it helps to have one sentence to design against

“A mark that looks like it belongs on a well-made tool that a small shop relies on every day — and that still reads clearly at the size of a browser tab.”

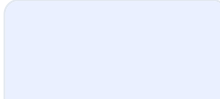
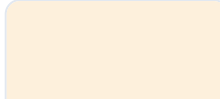
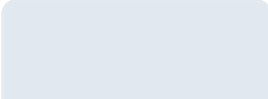
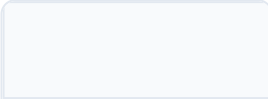
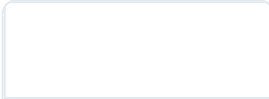
04 Colour

The product runs **three palettes**, scoped to three surfaces. This is already built and shipping. The logo has to survive all three.

PALETTE A • CUSTOMER-FACING

Trust Blue MARKETING SITE • SIGNUP • PRICING • EMAILS

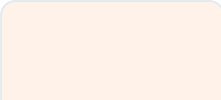
Everything a prospective seller sees before they pay. Deep blue does the credibility work; amber is the single warm highlight — used for eyebrows, numerals and emphasis, never for large areas.

 Primary #1E40AF Buttons, links, active state	 Deep #142A70 Gradient anchor	 Lift #2B57D6 Gradient top	 Amber #F59E0B Accent, emphasis	 Blue weak #EAF0FF Tinted fills	 Amber weak #FDF0DC Tinted fills
 Ink #0F172A Body text	 Muted #475569 Secondary text	 Line #E2E8F0 1px hairlines	 Ground #F8F AFC Page background	 Paper #FFFFFF Cards	

PALETTE B • THE WORKING APP

Desk Orange THE SELLER'S DAILY WORKSPACE

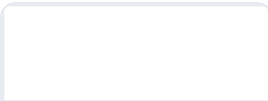
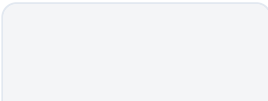
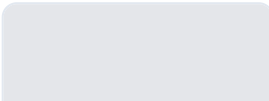
A deliberate separation: the moment a seller signs in, the interface changes temperature. Orange marks “you are inside your own tool now”, and it never appears on customer-facing surfaces. Green is reserved strictly for genuinely-positive states (paid, delivered).

 Accent #EA580C Primary action	 Accent weak #FFF2E8 Active nav item	 Positive #15803D Paid · delivered	 Warn #B7791F Pending	 Danger #B3402F Destructive	 Ink #1A1F36 Text
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PALETTE C • THE PUBLIC STOREFRONT

Monotone, per-shop THE BUYER'S VIEW

Ships near-black by default so the shop's own accent colour — which the owner picks, and which could be anything — becomes the only colour on the page. Our mark appears here at its smallest, greyest and least important.

 Default accent #0E1116 Overridable per shop	 Ground #FFFFFF Crisper than marketing	 Surface #F4F5F7 Insets	 Muted #5B6472 “powered by” line	 Line #E4E6EA Hairlines
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BRAND GRADIENTS IN USE



Hero wash. Marketing homepage — deep blue bleeding down into the page ground. #1E40AF → #2F5AD0 → #6F97EA → #F8FAFC



Brand panel. Signup / login split-screen and the call-to-action band. #142A70 → #1E40AF → #2B57D6

Both are soft, directional and low-contrast — they are atmosphere, not shape. The logo will frequently sit **on top of the second one**, which means a reversed (white / knockout) version is not optional.

The open question we'd like your recommendation on

The product uses two brand colours for two states — **blue** when we're selling to the seller, **orange** once they're working inside the tool. That separation is load-bearing in the UI and we don't want to collapse it.

So: which colour does the **logo** belong to? Three options as we see them — tell us which you'd defend, or propose a fourth.

OPTION A

Logo is blue

It matches the first impression — the site, the signup, every marketing graphic. Orange stays purely functional, a UI colour with no brand claim.

Simplest. Slight cost: the mark is a visitor inside the orange app.

OPTION B

Logo is ink / neutral

Near-black by default, tinted to whichever palette it sits in. Works everywhere, including inside a shop's own branding on the storefront.

Most flexible and most honest to the “quiet” attribute. Cost: less memorable in isolation.

OPTION C

Logo bridges both

A two-part mark — e.g. blue form, warm accent detail — that explains the storefront/desk duality the name already carries.

Most expressive. Cost: two-colour marks are the ones that break at 16 px and in print.

Non-negotiable colour requirements

Requirement	Why
Works in solid black	Printed order slips and PDF invoices render monochrome.
Works in solid white	Sits on the #142A70 → #2B57D6 panel and on photographic banners.
Works at one colour on white	The storefront footer credit, at roughly 10–11 px text height.
No baked-in gradient or shadow	The mark is re-coloured per surface; it must be flat vector.
Readable on a translucent dark bar	The marketing nav is white text over a blurred dark blue pill.
Never depends on amber alone	#F59E0B fails contrast on white at small sizes — it is a highlight colour only.

Four families are in production, scoped by surface. All are open-source and freely licensed. A wordmark drawn from — or sympathetic to — **Geist** would sit most naturally, but a bespoke drawing is welcome.

Geist

DISPLAY · HEADLINES · THE WORDMARK'S CLOSEST RELATIVE

Take orders from your DMs

Weight 600 at -0.03em tracking, line-height 1.06. Geometric, slightly condensed, neutral — modern without being trendy. Every marketing headline and the current wordmark use it. **If the wordmark is type-based, this is the reference point.**

Spline Sans

BODY · UI TEXT ON CUSTOMER-FACING SURFACES

A mini storefront your customers order from, plus an order desk that tracks every order.

Set at 16px base. Slightly technical, open apertures, holds up in long paragraphs on a phone. Weights 400 / 500 / 600 / 700.

IBM Plex Sans

THE DESK APP

Orders · Catalog

The seller's working interface. Chosen for density and number legibility — this UI is mostly tables of money and quantities.

IBM Plex Mono

LABELS · BUTTONS · DATA

MARK AS PACKED
NEW ORDER

Load-bearing brand texture: every button label and every eyebrow is uppercase mono at $0.12\text{--}0.16\text{em}$ tracking. More than the display face, **this is what makes the product look like itself.**

NOT BRAND FONTS — SHOP-SELECTABLE OPTIONS

Fraunces

Offered to Studio-tier shops as a serif option for their own storefront.

Nunito

The rounded option, same tier. Included here only so you know the range a shop can choose.

Why it matters

Our credit line can end up next to any of these. Another reason the mark must be self-sufficient rather than typographically dependent on its neighbours.

Typographic rules already enforced in code

- **No italics, anywhere.** A standing instruction. Emphasis is done with colour (amber) or weight, never slant — this applies to the wordmark and any tagline lockup.
- **Tight display tracking.** Headlines run -0.028em to -0.038em . A wordmark should feel similarly closed-up.
- **Mono uppercase for micro-labels.** 11px, weight 600, wide tracking. Consider whether a tagline lockup should follow this rather than the display face.
- **Sentence case in prose.** Title Case is not used. “Take orders from your DMs”, not “Take Orders From Your DMs”.

06 Design language

The visual vocabulary the mark will live inside. Summarised in one phrase the team has been using: **editorial-crisp**.

GEOMETRY

Corners are modest

Buttons 6px. Cards and panels 12px. The nav tile 6px at 24px square — roughly a 25% ratio. Nothing is a pill; nothing is a perfect circle. A mark built on a squared-off geometry will feel native; a very round one will not.

DEPTH

Borders, not shadows

Separation is done with 1px hairlines in #E2E8F0. The only shadow in the system is 0 1px 2px rgba(20, 32, 29, 0.04) — effectively invisible. The interface is flat and layered by line, not by elevation.

DENSITY

8px rhythm, tight but not cramped

Spacing steps on a 4/8px grid. Tables are compact because sellers scan dozens of orders. Whitespace is used for hierarchy, not for luxury.

COLOUR DISCIPLINE

One accent per surface

A screen gets one accent colour and a lot of neutral. Status colours (green, amber, red) are semantic and never decorative. The palette is wide but any single view uses a narrow slice of it.

A correction worth knowing about

The first version of the storefront was rejected in these words: **“the design is not clean and crisp, it's too rounded and generic.”** The rebuild tightened radii, flattened surfaces, removed decorative colour, made the default accent near-black, and leaned on mono micro-typography. **That is the aesthetic the logo needs to belong to** — precise and slightly austere, closer to a well-set document than to a consumer app.

FORMAL QUALITIES WE'D LIKE IN THE MARK

- Flat, single-weight, vector-clean
- Built from few shapes — countable at a glance
- Squared or softly-squared corners, matching 6px-at-24px
- Optically aligned rather than mathematically centred
- Recognisable as a silhouette with all colour removed
- Comfortable inside a rounded square container **and** free-standing

FORMAL QUALITIES TO AVOID

- Thin strokes below ~1.5px at 24px — they disappear
- Fine detail, small counters, or tight negative-space tricks
- More than two stroke weights
- Outline-only construction (breaks at favicon size)
- Perspective, isometry, or implied 3-D
- A mark that only works with the wordmark beside it

07 Where the logo lives

The most actionable section. These are real, measured placements taken from the shipping product — not hypothetical applications.

Placement	Size	Context & constraint
Marketing nav CRITICAL	24 × 24 px tile + 18 px wordmark	A sticky translucent dark-blue pill at the top of the homepage. White text. The tile sits immediately left of the wordmark with an 8 px gap. This is the smallest place the full lockup appears.
Browser favicon CRITICAL	16 · 32 · 48 px	Mark only, no wordmark. At 16 px roughly 3–4 pixels of usable detail per element. If the mark fails here it fails everywhere; design it here first.
Desk sidebar	~24 px mark + 15 px name	Top of the app's left nav rail, on a near-white ground (#F6F6F7) with the orange palette active. The seller sees this every working day — familiarity matters more than impact.
Signup / login panel	~28–32 px	Reversed out of the deep-blue gradient panel (#142A70 → #2B57D6). Requires the white / knockout version.
Storefront footer credit	~11 px text height	The line powered by SFDesk, in muted grey (#5B6472), on a buyer-facing page themed by the shop. Likely wordmark-only. Must read as a modest credit, not an advertisement.
Transactional email	~28 px header	Order notifications and onboarding, on white. Must render as a flat PNG — email clients do not reliably support SVG.
Printed order slip / PDF	~15–20 mm wide	Monochrome black on white, possibly a low-quality thermal print. No tints, no greys that could fill in.
Social avatar	400 × 400 px circle-cropped	Instagram and X crop to a circle. The mark needs a centred, circle-safe composition with padding — the square tile version will be clipped at the corners.
Open-graph / share card	1200 × 630 px	The only place the mark appears large. Should still hold up without added detail.
Marketing carousels	1080 × 1350 px	Instagram acquisition content, corner-placed over screenshots and flat colour. Needs both the dark and reversed versions.

ACTUAL PLACEMENTS, AT ACTUAL SIZE

 **SFDesk** Pricing FAQ
Marketing nav — 24px tile, reversed on gradient

 **SFDesk**
Desk sidebar — same tile, orange palette, light ground

powered by **SFDesk**

Storefront footer — muted credit, ~11px, shop's own theme around it



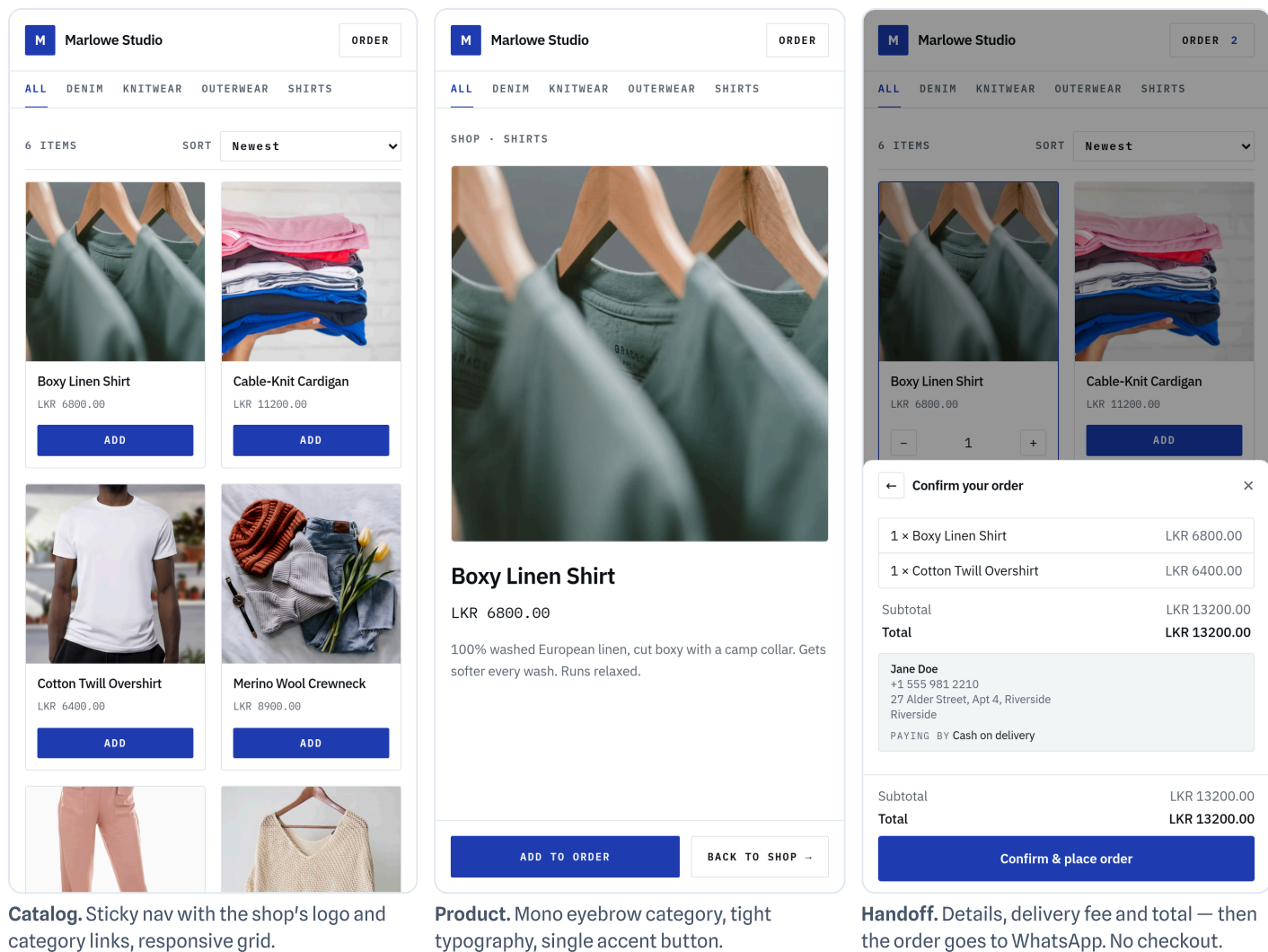
The size ladder every candidate should be tested against, on screen, before it is presented.

Summary of what this forces

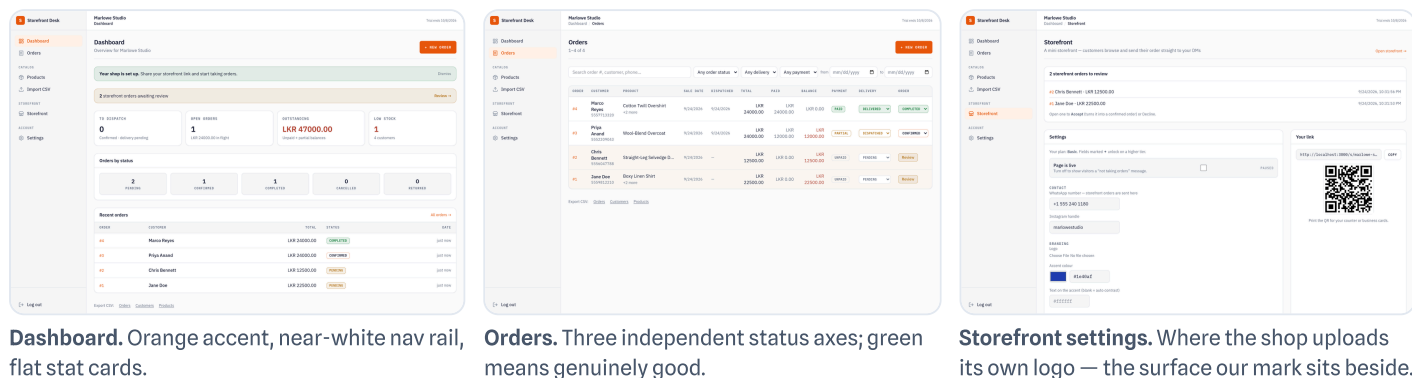
A **square-safe mark** that survives 16 px, a **circle-safe variant** for avatars, a **reversed version** for the blue gradient, a **one-colour black version** for print, and a **wordmark that can stand alone** at 11 px in grey. Five things, all derived from one idea.

08 The product in context

The buyer's side — the public storefront. Note the restraint: near-black accent, hairline borders, mono uppercase labels, generous product spacing.



The seller's side — the desk. Same discipline, warmer accent, much higher information density.



09 Deliverables & acceptance

What we need to ship the identity into a live product, and how we'll judge a candidate before committing.

LOCKUPS

- **Horizontal** — mark + wordmark, the primary lockup (nav, sidebar, email)
- **Stacked** — for square and centred placements
- **Mark only** — favicon, avatar, app tile
- **Wordmark only** — the footer credit and body-text mentions
- **Contained** — mark inside a 6px-radius rounded square, if the concept uses one

COLOURWAYS

- Full colour on white / light ground
- Reversed white, for the blue gradient and photography
- Solid black, one colour
- Solid white, one colour
- Muted grey #5B6472, for the storefront credit

FILES

- SVG master for every lockup and colourway, outlined paths, no embedded raster
- PNG at 1× / 2× / 3× on transparent ground
- Favicon set — 16 / 32 / 48 px plus a 512 px source, hand-tuned at 16
- 180 px Apple touch icon, 512 px maskable icon
- Editable source file (Figma or .ai)

SPECIFICATION

- Clear-space rule, expressed in units of the mark itself
- Minimum sizes — mark, and lockup, separately
- Exact hex values used, and how to re-colour per palette
- Misuse examples (what not to do)
- A one-page usage sheet we can hand to anyone making a carousel

How we'll test a candidate

Run these yourself before presenting — a concept that clears all seven is almost certainly the one.

- 01 Rendered at **16 px** on screen, is it still the same mark?
- 02 In **solid black** with no colour, does it still mean anything?
- 03 Reversed on #1E40AF, does it hold its weight?
- 04 **Circle-cropped** for an avatar, does it survive?
- 05 Next to a **shop's own logo** in the storefront footer, does it recede politely?
- 06 Beside the orange #EA580C app palette, does it clash?
- 07 Could it be **described over the phone** in one sentence?

PROCESS WE'D SUGGEST

1. Pick two or three territories from section 03 and sketch broadly, black and white only. 2. Show us 3–4 directions at 24 px and 200 px side by side, before any colour or refinement. 3. We pick one, you refine it and build out the colourways, lockups and spec.

LATITUDE

The palette, type and design language in this document are shipping and unlikely to move. The mark is completely open — including the possibility that it is purely typographic, or that the tile container disappears entirely. If a strong idea needs one of the constraints in section 07 relaxed, propose it rather than working around it.

One line to keep in mind. This is a tool for one person running a shop from their phone, who is trusting us with the orders that pay their rent. Everything in the identity should make that feel like a sensible decision.